Xiang Li

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Education

The University of Chicago (QS: 24) Chicago, USA | Oct 2025 – Jun 2026
Master of Arts in Digital Media Studies
Major Courses: Artificial Intelligence and the Humanities, Driven User Interfaces and Technology, Game Design, Data Visualization, Scientific Data Publishing, Data Analysis, Introduction to Digital Humanities, etc.

School of the Art Institute of Chicago Chicago, USA | Sep 2021 – Jan 2025
BFA in Fine Arts

Internship Experience

ByteDance, Douyin E-commerce Department, Interaction Design Intern Shanghai, China | Apr 2026 – Jun 2026

- **Project Overview:** Spearheaded the 0-to-1 product design of the AI-powered shopping assistant module for Douyin E-commerce search, front-loading Large Language Model capabilities to the search page to cover omni-tag scenarios;
- **Competitive Research:** Benchmarked mainstream e-commerce platforms including Douyin, Taobao, and JD.com centered on AI shopping assistant scenarios; deconstructed core funnels spanning intent understanding, clarification prompts, product recommendations, price comparisons, and purchase conversions via empirical testing of diverse user queries; established unified user experience analysis dimensions and delivered competitive insights;
- **UX Analysis:** Evaluated the AI assistant experience across dimensions including entry points, recommendation cards, progressive disclosure, parameter readability, algorithmic transparency, page redirects, and checkout flows; identified product discrepancies and usability friction across platforms during the "AI response → screening and comparison → purchase decision" journey;
- **Solution Design:** Co-architected the AI assistant decision-making funnels and high-fidelity prototypes; modularized information including price breakdowns, user reviews, and core parameters into drill-down decision drivers; engineered a unified interaction flow of "recommendation → in-depth explanation → return to final selection", minimizing cognitive load and decision friction;
- **Methodology Consolidation:** Translated ambiguous user requirements into actionable product features and information hierarchies; formulated an AI product analysis framework spanning from problem discovery and solution design to UX validation via competitive research, user journey deconstruction, information architecture, and prototype iterations;

Fathia, User Operations Department, User Data Analysis Intern Chicago, USA | Feb 2024 – Mar 2024

- **Data Collection**: Developed data collection scripts in Python, leveraged official YouTube APIs to collect over 100,000 public user behavior records, completed data stream filtering and cleaning with an effective rate of over 85%, and built a structured user persona tagging system with 20+ dimensions, supporting potential customer identification and precise segmentation;
- **LLM-Enabled Personalization**: Used large language models to generate 500+ personalized marketing emails in batch, increasing content-production efficiency by approximately 60% and tailoring messaging to user-profile segments;
- **Business Impact**: Iterated marketing strategy through data analysis, shortening the content-production cycle by approximately 40%, increasing the average email open rate to 25%+, and improving lead conversion by approximately 15%, supporting more targeted marketing decisions;

Hangzhou Tuwei Digital Intelligence Technology Hangzhou, China | Jun 2023 – Sep 2023
Project Department, 3D Visualization Intern

- **3D Modeling**: Created 10+ 1:1 high-fidelity 3D models of petroleum equipment in 3ds Max and V-Ray, optimizing polygon counts by 30%+ while delivering 4K renders and 4096px textures; refined topology for smooth performance in real-time visualization engines;
- **Delivery & Collaboration**: Delivered 30+ production-quality digital assets under industrial visualization standards with 100% on-time delivery and a 60% reuse rate; collaborated closely with a five-person development team to integrate assets into downstream visualization systems and maintain project schedule and usability;

Personal Projects

Brave Companions — Game Development, Developer Chicago, USA | Feb 2026 – Mar 2026

- **Core Gameplay**: Independently developed a 2D local co-op platformer in Unity and C#, writing 3,000+ lines of code and implementing dual-character controls with 5+ actions/skills per character plus 8+ core systems including combat, coin collection, and survival mechanics;
- **Level Design**: Handcrafted six levels across forest, cave, and snow biomes, built pixel-art environments, configured 8+ enemy types and 30+ collectibles, and independently integrated digital assets and developed the UI system; released the game on itch.io and reached 500+ plays;

Team Projects

Flock Camera Data Physicalization Installation Chicago, USA | Apr 2026 – May 2026
Team Project, 5 Members, Core Member

- **Tangible Interaction**: Built a data-physicalization system using six Sony toio robots and projection mapping, translating

the locations of 595 Chicago ALPR cameras and neighborhood socioeconomic data into a physical installation; synchronized robot movement, lighting, and alerts to make surveillance detection logic and spatial coverage physically perceptible;
- **Interaction Design**: Integrated camera geospatial data with six socioeconomic dimensions and designed a coordinated six-robot interaction model—one robot for map-region selection, one to simulate vehicle movement, and four to represent cameras—using robot clustering to visualize concentrated surveillance and encourage critical reflection on data narratives and media simplification;

Ocean Intelligence Visualization Remote | Nov 2024 – Mar 2025

Team Project, 5 Members, Core Member

- **Data Engineering**: Processed 10+ million global ocean-data records across 5+ sources; built AI agents with Coze and DeepSeek and used REST APIs to automate data collection and processing, yielding 8 million cleaned records, improving processing efficiency by 70%, and achieving 95%+ data accuracy;
- **3D Visualization**: Developed a data-visualization dashboard and dynamic presentation pages with Svelte and contributed to 3D marine-environment modeling; combined dynamic data binding and rendering optimization to present multidimensional data through immersive interaction and detailed environmental visualization;

Awards & Honors

2025: University of Chicago Excellence Scholarship, US$20,000;
2021–2025: School of the Art Institute of Chicago Creative Honors Scholarship, US$54,000;
2025: Bronze Award, Zhejiang Province 'Challenge Cup' College Students' Extracurricular Academic Science and Technology Competition, 'AI+' Special Track;

Campus Experience

School of the Art Institute of Chicago Chicago, USA | Feb 2024 – Jun 2024

Stage Design & Scenic Construction Lead

- Led visual-style coordination and scenic composition design for two theater productions in Chicago;

Skills

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent);
Technical: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C/C++, Java, C#, SQL, SvelteKit, Tailwind CSS, REST API, Git/GitHub, Vercel, Streamlit, Excel, Unity, Unreal Engine 5, Arduino;
Design: Figma, Photoshop, Illustrator, Premiere, Blender, Fusion 360, 3ds Max / V-Ray, 3D Printing, Dashboard Design;
Interests: AI, Painting, Sports.